

goods and any tangible item between floors or levels of a building since as far back as we can remember. Primitive elevators were operated by humans, animals or water wheel power. In early 19th century steam-driven elevators were used in England. Later, hydraulic elevators replaced these. The hydraulic elevator is supported by a heavy piston, moving in a cylinder, and operated by the water (or oil) pressure produced by pumps. In 1853, Elisha Graves Otis created the brakes used in modern elevators which paved the way for skyscrapers. Italy is the nation with the maximum number of elevators, followed closely by the United States of America. The future of elevators is not however limited to Earth. The concept for a space elevator was first published in 1895 by Konstantin Tsiolkovsky. A space elevator (or beanstalk) is a proposed type of space transportation system. The futuristic structure from sci-fi movies would consist a ribbon-like cable (a.k.a tether) anchored to the surface near the equator and extending to space beyond the geostationary orbit. But again, it's a long way to go before this idea can reach fruition.

Encryption

While 'hacking' is now used interchangeably to mean 'computer hackers', confidential data and private messages have been intercepted since the beginning of civilization. Encryption, the art of scrambling data to ensure its readability by only the intended recipient is not a new concept. If you went through the FastTrack on Cryptography we published last year, you'd probably already have detailed knowledge about how this works. Encryption doesn't fall in the classical category of invention since it's a concept, not a tool one could touch and feel. It didn't find widespread use

